



# Data Day 2027 — Ways to Participate (DRAFT)

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**Audience:** outward / participant-facing (website + Call for Proposals packet). **Status:** working draft. Placeholders in **[brackets]** need confirmation (dates, links, the program committee's name). Voice follows the Regional Data Agenda — mission-forward and inviting.

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## Plotting What's Next

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### *Five years forward for Central Ohio's data community*

Data Day returns for its **fifth year** on **Tuesday, February 16, 2027** — and this milestone is a launch pad, not a look back. Across five years, Data Day has convened Central Ohio's public-sector data community — **local governments, nonprofits, educational institutions, and civic-minded businesses** — around a shared vision: **to make Central Ohio a leader in using data to improve the quality of life for all residents.** *Plotting What's Next* turns that momentum toward what comes next, and we want you in the room helping shape it.

There are many ways to take part — whether you want to present your work, lead a hands-on session, share a research poster, or connect with peers across the region. Explore the formats below and find the one that fits.

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## Present at Data Day

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### Lecture sessions

#### *Open call for proposals*

The backbone of the program. A lecture is a **45-minute breakout** (with time built in for questions and discussion) in which you share a project, method, dataset, tool, or lesson learned with a room of practitioners. Sessions span all skill levels — from introductory to advanced — and we welcome proposals from across the four constituencies.

- **Format:** 45 minutes, including Q&A.
- **Rooms:** Terrace A, Terrace B, or the Grand Ballroom.

- **Who can propose:** anyone — individuals or teams.
- **What to tell us:** title, objectives, description, intended audience and skill level, and speaker(s).  
(Full question list under “What we’ll ask you to submit” below.)

## Hands-on workshops

*Open call for proposals*

A **90-minute, technically focused working session** where participants follow along and build something — a workshop is for skills, tools, and methods that are best learned by doing. Workshops are held in a classroom-style room with tables and power; attendees are expected to bring a laptop.

- **Format:** 90 minutes, hands-on; participants work along with the facilitator.
- **Room:** Grand Ballroom B (technical setup — tables, power).
- **Who can propose:** anyone comfortable leading an interactive, applied session.
- **What to tell us:** title, learning goals, the tools/skills covered, any prerequisites or setup attendees need, and the skill level.

## Panel discussions

*Curated by the program committee*

A **moderated, multi-speaker conversation** on a regional data topic, assembled by the [program committee] to bring balanced perspectives to the stage. Panels are not part of the open call — but if you have a topic or potential panelists to suggest, we’d love to hear from you.

- **Format:** 45 minutes, moderated, multiple speakers.
- **Room:** Grand Ballroom.
- **How to take part:** [\[suggest a panel topic or panelist →\]](#) (link / form TBD).

## Choosing a skill level

Every session carries a **technical skill level (0–3)** in the agenda so attendees can find sessions that match their comfort. When you submit, tell us where your session fits:

| Level                    | Who it’s for                                                               |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>0 — All audiences</b> | No technical background needed; conceptual, strategic, or policy-oriented. |
| <b>1 — Beginner</b>      | Some data familiarity helpful; introduces a tool or method.                |
| <b>2 — Intermediate</b>  | Assumes working knowledge; hands-on with specific tools/methods.           |
| <b>3 — Advanced</b>      | For experienced practitioners; deep or specialized technical content.      |

We aim for a program that spans all four levels — entry points for newcomers *and* depth for seasoned practitioners are equally welcome.

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## Spotlight on emerging talent

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### Intern Showcase — lightning talks

*By invitation / selection*

A fast-paced, plenary lightning round over lunch that puts **emerging data talent** in front of the full Data Day audience. The Showcase features interns from **MORPC's Summer Internship Program**, who are placed with local governments and institutions across the region and bring fresh perspective to real public-sector data work.

- **Format:** short lightning talks (~5–7 minutes each), presented to the full room during lunch.
  - **Who's eligible:** participants in MORPC's Summer Internship Program.
  - **How it works:** interns submit their projects; a selection committee chooses a few for the lightning talks. **Projects not selected for a talk are invited to present as posters** (see below) — one submission, two ways to shine.
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## Share your research — posters

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Poster presentations are displayed throughout the venue all day, with dedicated **attended poster times** during breaks and lunch when presenters stand by their work to talk with attendees. Two groups feed the poster gallery:

### Intern posters

Accepted **intern projects not selected for lightning talks** are presented as posters — giving every accepted intern a place on the program.

### Student poster Call for Proposals

*Open call for proposals — Central Ohio students*

We invite **college, university, and graduate students** from across the region to submit posters sharing their data-driven research, analysis, or applied projects. The student poster CFP is a chance to share your work with the region's data community, get feedback from practitioners, and make connections early in your career.

- **Who can propose:** currently enrolled college, university, and graduate students at Central Ohio institutions.
  - **Format:** printed poster, displayed all day; you'll staff it during attended poster times.
  - **What to tell us:** title, abstract, your program/institution, and advisor (if any).
  - **Specs:** [poster size/orientation, board vs. easel, setup time — TBD].
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## Exhibit & connect

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Organizations and vendors are invited to **table in the Gallery** for the full day — a high-traffic space during registration, breaks, and lunch — to connect with the region's data community, showcase tools and services, and support the event. Tabling is part of Data Day's [sponsorship / exhibitor program → link TBD].

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## Attend the keynotes

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Every attendee shares two plenary moments: a **morning keynote** to open the day and a **lunch keynote**. Keynote speakers are invited by the program committee. Have someone inspiring in mind? [Suggest a keynote →](#)

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## What we'll ask you to submit (by format)

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A quick preview of the questions each submission form will cover. Items marked (*internal*) help MORPC staff understand and balance the program — they aren't printed in the agenda.

### Lecture

- Applicant name and contact (primary contact for the proposal)
- Speaker(s) and organizational affiliations
- Session title (≤10 words)
- Up to three session objectives — what the audience will gain or learn
- Session description (≤100 words) — the “why attend this session?” blurb for the brochure
- Session abstract (longer) — content, topics, format, intended audience, expected outcomes
- Intended audience (e.g., decision-makers, data professionals, subject-matter experts, other)
- Technical skill level (0–3)
- Regional Data Agenda **focus area** (*internal*)

- Regional Data Agenda **action pillar** (*internal*)
- Reflection: “How does your session advance [focus area] as a regional data priority?” (*internal*)
- How you’ll engage the audience / encourage participation
- AV and technology needs

## Workshop

*Everything in the lecture list, plus the hands-on specifics:* - Learning goals — what participants will build or be able to do afterward - Tools and software used - Prerequisites — what attendees should already know - Required setup beforehand (installs, accounts) and whether a laptop is needed - Ideal group size / any participant cap - Special room, power, or AV needs

## Panel (*suggestion*)

- Your name and contact (the person suggesting the panel)
- Proposed panel topic / working title
- Why this topic matters to the region now
- Key questions or angles the panel would explore
- Suggested moderator and/or panelists with affiliations (optional)
- (*Focus area, action pillar, and skill level are assigned by staff.*)

## Intern Showcase — lightning talk or poster

*One submission; the committee selects lightning talks, and remaining projects become posters.* - Intern name and contact - Internship host organization / placement - Project title - Project summary — the question, the data, what you did, and the result - Why it matters — impact for the host organization or community - Any visuals or slides you’d use (optional)

## Student poster

- Student name and contact
  - Institution and program; advisor (if any)
  - Poster title
  - Abstract — research/project summary: question, data and methods, findings or status
  - (*Posters carry no skill/focus tags; see poster specs for size and format.*)
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## Key dates & how to submit

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| Milestone                                                       | Date                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Call for Proposals opens (lectures, workshops, student posters) | [TBD]                      |
| Proposal deadline                                               | [TBD]                      |
| Notifications                                                   | [TBD]                      |
| Data Day 2027                                                   | Tuesday, February 16, 2027 |

**Submit / suggest:** [\[CFP link — TBD\]](#) · [Suggest a keynote](#) · [\[contact email — TBD\]](#)

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*Questions? Contact the Data Day team at [\[email\]](#).*